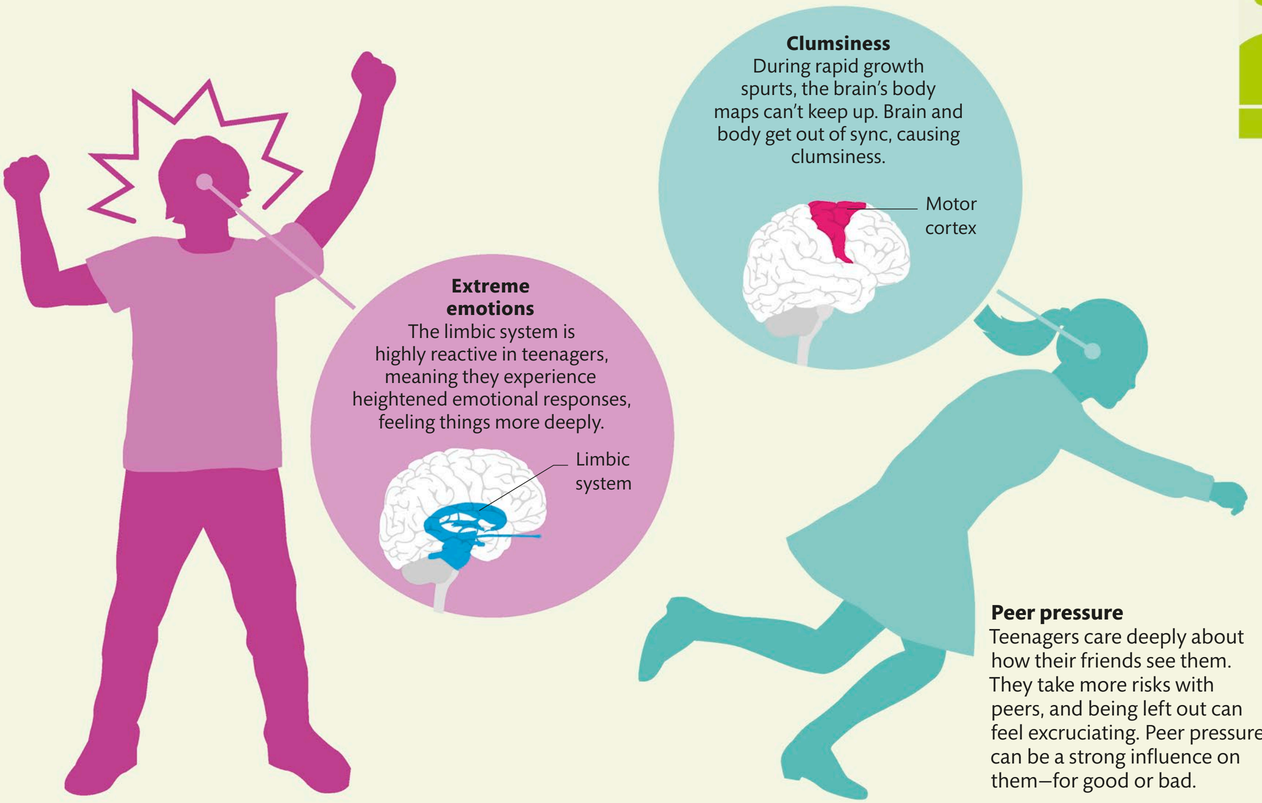
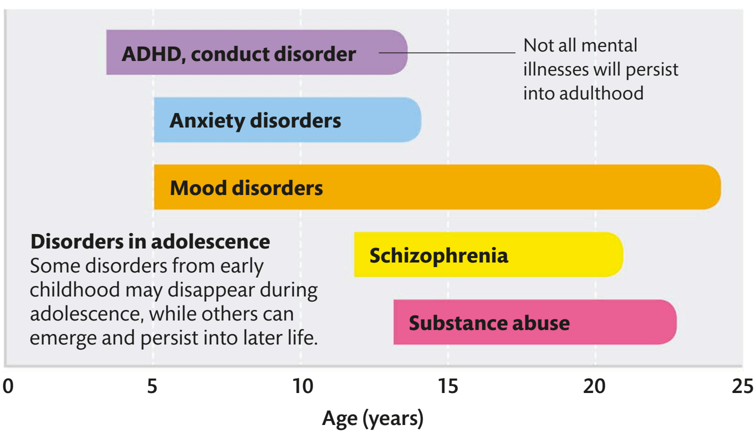
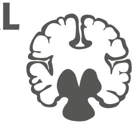


Mental health risks

Some of the brain areas that undergo the most dramatic changes during adolescence have been linked with mental ill-health. These changes can leave the brain vulnerable to small issues becoming dysfunctions. This may explain why so many mental health problems, from schizophrenia to anxiety disorders, commonly appear during adolescence.



THE BRAIN REACHES ITS **LARGEST PHYSICAL SIZE** BETWEEN **AGES 11 AND 14**



WHY ARE TEENS SELF-CONSCIOUS?

When we think about being embarrassed, a region of our prefrontal cortex linked to understanding mental states is more active in teenagers than adults.